MMSU's Commitment

Take an active role in protecting and promoting sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, responsible land use, and biodiversity conservation.

SDG 15.2.1 · Events about sustainable use of land

Support or organise events aimed to promote conservation and sustainable utilisation of the land, including forests and wild land.

Evidence year: 2025 (calendar year), with continuing implementation 2024–2026

Evidence from 2025

CAFSD Graduands Plant Native Trees and Bamboo in the University Forest Reserves



CAFSD Graduating Class 2025 "Bamboo and Tree Planting Activity," University Forest Reserves, City of Batac, 2 July 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)



Bamboo planting site in the University Forest Reserve, Brgy. Mabaleng, 2 July 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)

Some 230 graduating students of the College of Agriculture, Food and Sustainable Development (CAFSD) of Mariano Marcos State University (MMSU) planted trees and bamboo in the University Forest Reserves in Barangays Payao and Mabaleng, City of Batac, on July 2, 2025. The activity was led by CAFSD OIC-Dean Charlie Batin and the 2025 CAFSD Graduating Class Student Council, with Dr. Joselito Rosario, Director for Agribusiness, and Mr. Bonne Jovie Orteza of the MMSU Bamboo Research and Development Center. MMSU President Virgilio Julius P. Manzano Jr. commended the class for leaving a lasting green footprint that will further preserve the forest areas managed by the university, and Mr. Hashler Garalde, a CAFSD alumnus representing the Provincial Government of Ilocos Norte, supported the college's sustainability efforts.

The graduands planted 120 seedlings of guijo and yakal, native dipterocarp timber species raised at the MMSU Central Nursery, in the Payao Forest Reserve, and 130 propagules of kawayan tinik, machiku and giant bamboo from the MMSU Bamboo Nursery in Mabaleng.

Source

- MMSU News, "CAFSD graduands plant trees, bamboos in Batac forest reserves," 4 July 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/article/news/2468/cafsd-graduands-plant-trees-bamboos-in-batac-forest-reserves
- MMSU News, "BS Forestry seniors leave green footprints with pre-graduation tree planting," 11 July 2024 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/article/news/2065/bs-forestry-seniors-leave-green-footprints-with-pre-graduation-tree-planting

MMSU Plants 250 Mangrove Propagules in Currimao on World Environment Day



Mangrove planting for World Environment Day, Brgy. Maglaoi, Currimao, June 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)



MMSU, LGU Currimao, DENR and fisherfolk volunteers at the planting site, June 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)

In June 2025, in celebration of World Environment Day, Mariano Marcos State University planted 250 mangrove propagules along the coastal area of Barangay Maglaoi, Currimao, Ilocos Norte, to restore degraded shorelines, enhance climate resilience and promote sustainable coastal resource management. The activity was spearheaded by the MMSU Sustainability and Futures Thinking (SFT) Office with the Local Government Unit of Currimao and led by Dr. Mee Jay Domingo, Vice President for Planning and Strategic Foresight.

MMSU faculty, education support personnel and students joined representatives of the Department of Environment and Natural Resources, barangay officials, members of local fisherfolk organizations and community members. SFT Director Dr. Arlene Gonzales explained that mangroves were chosen because they act as natural filters that intercept plastic waste from land before it reaches the sea, while absorbing carbon, protecting shorelines from erosion and providing habitat for marine life.

Source

- MMSU News, "MMSU plants 250 mangrove propagules in Currimao," 11 June 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-plants-250-mangrove-propagules-in-currimao

Green Wall Program: Coconut Seedlings for the Currimao Coastline



Coconut seedling planting along the Currimao beachfront under the MMSU Green Wall Program, 24 July 2025. (Photo: MMSU)

On July 24, 2025, MMSU planted coconut seedlings along the Currimao beachfront under its Green Wall Program, with 1,000 seedlings donated by the Philippine Coconut Authority (PCA), to promote environmental sustainability and coastal resilience amid growing climate threats. The activity was held in celebration of the birthday of CHED Chairperson Shirley C. Agrupis, Chair of the MMSU Board of Regents.

MMSU President Virgilio Julius P. Manzano Jr., PCA Ilocos Norte Agriculturist and In-Charge Rose Ann Cabaloan, and university officials and employees took part. CASAT OIC-Dean Pilar Carolyn Pascual highlighted the university's commitment to protecting coastal ecosystems through the Green Wall project.

Source

- MMSU News, "MMSU celebrates CHED Chair Agrupis' birthday with coconut planting activity," 28 July 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-celebrates-ched-chair-agrupis-birthday-with-coconut-planting-activity

MMSU Promotes Regenerative Farming at the 2025 NSTW Forum



Forum series of the 2025 National Science and Technology Week, Northwestern University, Laoag City, 19 November 2025. (Photo: MMSU)

On November 19, 2025, MMSU Research Director Dr. Dionisio Bucao served as a resource speaker at the forum series of the 2025 National Science and Technology Week held at Northwestern University, Laoag City. He presented regenerative farming approaches that restore soil health, biodiversity and ecosystem function, and emphasized carbon sequestration, improved soil fertility, water conservation and climate resilience through natural processes, as well as how regenerative farming differs from conventional practice.

Source

- MMSU News, “MMSU researchers share expertise on smart agriculture in NSTW forum,” 20 November 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-researchers-share-expertise-on-smart-agriculture-in-nstw-forum

President's Farm Field Day Showcases Climate-Resilient Rice Varieties



President's Farm technology demonstration of inbred and hybrid rice varieties, 28 October 2025. (Photo: MMSU)



Farmers, LGU technicians and students at the President's Farm Field Day, in front of CAFSD. (Photo: MMSU)

On October 28, 2025, the MMSU Extension Directorate, with the Philippine Rice Research Institute (PhilRice) Batac Branch, held the President's Farm Field Day: A Technology Showcase in front of the College of Agriculture, Food and Sustainable Development. Farmers and farmer-leaders, agricultural technicians from Ilocos Norte local government units, BS Agriculture students, and MMSU and PhilRice rice specialists viewed eight rice varieties grown under wet-season conditions.

The varieties included four newly released by PhilRice, two public hybrids, and two suited to saline and rainfed conditions, among them NSIC Rc 686 (Salinas 39) and NSIC Rc 650 (Sahod Ulan 36), giving farmers options for saline-affected and rainfed fields. Speakers included MMSU President Dr. Virgilio Julius P. Manzano Jr., Extension Director Dr. Marlowe Aquino, and former MMSU President and PhilRice Executive Director Dr. Santiago R. Obien.

Source

- MMSU News, "MMSU President's Farm showcases 8 rice varieties," 4 November 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/article/news/2665/mmsu-presidents-farm-showcases-8-rice-varieties

2025 International Day for Biological Diversity Wildlife Photo Contest



Contest poster with the animal-photography ethical guidelines (deadline 30 May 2025).



Winner Chris Jeremiah C. Antonio receives his certificate from Dr. Arlene L. Gonzales, Chief of Sustainability and Futures Thinking.

MMSU, through its Office of Sustainability and Futures Thinking, marked the 2025 International Day for Biological Diversity with a Wildlife Photo Contest that invited the university community to document local wildlife and promote awareness of biodiversity conservation. Entrants followed animal-photography ethical guidelines: avoiding flash and loud noises, never using bait or food lures, following local laws and warning signs, keeping clear of nesting sites and sensitive habitats, and captioning photographs honestly. Entries were received until May 30, 2025.

Chris Jeremiah C. Antonio, a third-year BA Communication student, was named winner and received a ₱1,000 gift voucher and a certificate from Dr. Arlene L. Gonzales, Chief of Sustainability and Futures Thinking.

Source

- MMSU SDG 15 Life on Land report (2025), Office of Sustainability and Futures Thinking

Continuing implementation

Policies and programmes that began before 2025 and continue to be implemented, with 2024 and 2026 activities that show the programme is ongoing. THE accepts policies that are already in place.

Graduation Tree Planting Is a Standing MMSU Programme, 2024 to 2026

Continuing implementation · July 2024, July 2025, June 2026



CAFSD Graduating Class 2026 enrichment planting at the MMSU Forest Reserve, Payao, 1 June 2026. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)

Graduating classes of the College of Agriculture, Food and Sustainable Development (CAFSD) of Mariano Marcos State University (MMSU) plant trees before they graduate, and the planting has been repeated every year. On July 9, 2024, the BS Forestry graduating class, led by CAFSD OIC-Dean Charlie Batin, enriched the Salinged Park, the university's ecological park, with igem-dagat, balitbitan, bitaog, Cassia javanica and banaba. On July 2, 2025, 230 CAFSD graduands planted guijo, yakal and bamboo in the University Forest Reserves in Payao and Mabaleng, City of Batac.

On June 1, 2026, the CAFSD Graduating Class of 2026, led by its Student Council with the chairs and faculty of the Departments of Environmental Science and Forestry, carried out an enrichment planting at the MMSU Forest Reserve in Payao, which the CAFSD Batch 2025 had previously planted with native seedlings. They planted 50 banaba, 30 yakal saplungan and 20 guijo seedlings at the onset of the rainy season, hardened in the MMSU Forest Tree Nursery, species chosen because they improve soil quality, conserve biodiversity and absorb and store carbon dioxide. Dr. Arlene Gonzales, Director of the Sustainability and Futures Thinking Office, represented the University President and commended the college for sustaining the initiative. The activity follows Republic Act 10800, the Graduation Legacy for the Environment Act, which requires students to plant trees before graduation.

Source

- MMSU News, "BS Forestry seniors leave green footprints with pre-graduation tree planting," 11 July 2024 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/article/news/2065/bs-forestry-seniors-leave-green-footprints-with-pre-graduation-tree-planting
- MMSU News, "CAFSD graduands plant trees, bamboos in Batac forest reserves," 4 July 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/article/news/2468/cafsd-graduands-plant-trees-bamboos-in-batac-forest-reserves
- MMSU News, "CAFSD graduands grow native trees at MMSU forest reserve," 5 June 2026 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/cafsd-graduands-grow-native-trees-at-mmsu-forest-reserve